

VEGETABLES · QUICK

Aloo *Fry*

***The simplest, most satisfying thing.** Little cubes of potato fried crisp with mustard, cumin and green chilies. It's a five-ingredient weekday side that turns rice and dal into a proper meal. The trick is holding the salt till the end — that's what keeps the edges crisp.*

from the kitchen of Noor

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A QUICK WEEKDAY SIDE • CRISP POTATOES, READY FAST

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

- potatoes, peeled & cut into small pieces
- olive oil, for frying
- mustard seeds (rai)
- cumin seeds (zira)
- green chilies, for flavour
- turmeric (haldi), a good pinch
- red chili powder, to finish
- salt (namak) — added at the end

Salt at the END for crisp potatoes — salting early draws out water and softens them. Amounts by feel.

HOW WE MAKE IT

- 1 Temper the oil.** Heat olive oil and add the mustard seeds and cumin. Wait until they splutter.
- 2 Green chilies.** Add the green chilies for flavour.
- 3 Add the potatoes.** Tip in the cut potatoes and the turmeric. Toss to coat.
- 4 Fry crisp.** Fry on medium-high heat, stirring often, until the potatoes are cooked all the way through and as crisp as you like.
- 5 Season to finish.** Only now add the red chili powder and salt. Toss through.
- 6 Serve.** Lovely with warm rice, a spoon of ghee and dal.

Amma's note: don't rush the frying and don't crowd the pan — that's how you get crisp edges instead of steamed potatoes. Keep the salt for the very end.